

THE APOSTLES' FAST & WHY WE FAST

SESSION 00.9 HANDOUT

NAME _____ DATE _____

♦ MEMORY VERSE — COPY BY HAND

These are the words of the Prophet Isaiah, spoken hundreds of years before Christ. They are the deepest teaching on what fasting is really for. Copy the verse below twice in your best handwriting.

Is this not the fast I have chosen — to loose the bonds of wickedness, to undo the heavy burdens, to let the oppressed go free, and that you bring to your house the poor who are cast out? — Isaiah 58:6–7

♦ VOCABULARY — MATCH EACH WORD TO ITS MEANING

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

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| FASTING | • | • The longest and strictest fast of the Orthodox year — the forty days before Pascha. You will keep your first one next March. |
| WEDNESDAY | • | • Saying <i>no</i> to certain foods (meat, dairy, eggs, sometimes fish, sometimes oil) for spiritual reasons — to free the soul, not to harm the body. |
| FRIDAY | • | • The day Christ was crucified. Orthodox Christians fast every week on this day to share, in a small way, in the Cross. |
| GREAT LENT | • | • The day Judas went to the chief priests to betray Christ. Orthodox Christians fast every week on this day to remember the betrayal — and to repent. |

♦ CALENDAR — THE FOUR FASTS OF THE ORTHODOX YEAR

Use the word bank to fill in each blank. **Word bank:** *Great Fast · Apostles' Fast · Dormition Fast · Nativity Fast*

WHEN	WHICH FAST?	LEADS TO WHICH FEAST?
40 days before Pascha (early year)	_____	Pascha
Mon after All Saints to June 28	_____	Sts. Peter and Paul (June 29)
August 1 to August 14	_____	Dormition of the Theotokos (Aug 15)
November 15 to December 24	_____	The Nativity of Christ (Dec 25)

♦ SKETCH — TWO DAYS A WEEK, EVERY WEEK

Draw a simple weekly calendar in the box below. Circle **Wednesday** and **Friday**. Above Wednesday, write: *Judas betrayed Christ*. Above Friday, write: *Christ was crucified*. These are little Lents — every week, for the rest of your life.

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
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✦ REFLECTION — WRITE 3 TO 5 SENTENCES

The lesson said fasting is not about the food — it is about the heart. When you kept your first Apostles' Fast, what did you notice? Was it about giving up cheese — or did you notice something deeper happening? Write 3 to 5 sentences. *It's okay if you mostly noticed being hungry. It's okay if you don't know yet. It's okay if you messed up sometimes — the lesson said so. Just write what was real for you.*
